Roses In December

by Gregg Moeller



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DAVID. How does one say goodbye to a memory? Ah, the beauty of my dreams, the love of my life….

ANN. I'm not really here. Well, I am. You'll figure it out soon enough.

DAVID. A picture of you on the wall, your beauty radiates like the sun.

ANN. Well this is getting good. It better be about me.

DAVID. My own, beloved Ann…

ANN. SCORE!

DAVID. Beauty, Grace, Passion…uh…

ANN. Splendor?

DAVID. Splendor! No, that sounds stupid.

ANN. Stupid? Okay, how about "charitable" for dating you for four years?

DAVID. Ah, how about fiery, nagging, frustratingly bitchy Ann…

ANN. Hold on there, cowboy!

DAVID. HA! Thought I didn't know you were there, didn't you?

ANN. Whoo. I'm the memory that you conjured up, dork.

DAVID. You know, although it sounds pretty weird, death worked well for you.

ANN. Thanks. And you—you're still breathing well.

INTRODUCTION

ANN. Ah—the successful writer, busy creating another masterpiece.

DAVID. Hey, lay off, all right? I'm working here.

ANN. That's a doodle.

DAVID. So? I like to doodle.

ANN. Rorshach has nothing on you. That's either a horse wearing a dress or a frog doing…god knows what.

DAVID. You were always great at ignoring the situation at hand, weren't you?

ANN. Oooh—here comes the "struggling artist" stuff again…blah blah blah.

DAVID. God, I figured once you were dead, I'd be the one at peace. Now it's worse than ever!

ANN. So, what did you expect of me? Some horrid spooky corpse?

DAVID. No, you are I've always remembered you: beautiful and a royal pain.

ANN. Well, I AM as you remember me. So, whatcha writing?

DAVID. If you MUST know, I am writing a novel about you and me.

ANN. Well, that explains me being here. Is it dirty?

DAVID. It most certainly is NOT. I'm writing about how we first met.

ANN. Oh, when the whole mess started. That should be refreshing. Let's see…it was at…uh…

DAVID. You don't remember, do you? And I'm the one who forgot everything important!

ANN. Hey back off! I'm just a memory as well, so be glad I remember your name, Danny.

DAVID. Cute.

ANN. It just so happens that I was going on a blind date with a guy named Paul—and I was supposed to meet him at a party…

(Flashback)

ANN. Oh, DAVID!

DAVID. Yes.

ANN. You are—a GOD!

DAVID. Why, thank you.

ANN. Who needs Paul when I have YOU!

DAVID. Hey. I am a slice of something special.

ANN. Everything about you is just….just….

DAVID. Magnificent?

ANN. YES! And…and…

DAVID. Macho?

ANN. YES! I am simply not worthy to beg your affections.

DAVID. Oh, please beg, beg away.

ANN. (*drops to her knees*) David—your eyes, your tousled hair, your rippling muscles, your healthy musk odor, your neatly ironed pants, your collection of Flintstones jelly glasses…it all is just…just…

DAVID. Eye candy for the chicks?

ANN. YES!! Now we must start kissing like its CPR FINALS WEEK! Come to Mama, you FIERY LOVE BEAST!

(*ANN Grabs DAVID, swings him around as if to kiss him roughly, then drops him as they return to the present scene.)*

ANN. You are one sick, twisted little monkey.

DAVID. Must you ruin everything?

ANN. It went <u>nothing</u> like that.

DAVID. Hey—It went a LOT like that. My pants are always neatly ironed.

ANN. You are a pervert. You really remember it like that? "Magnificent? Macho? Eye candy for the chicks?"

DAVID. Well, my memory of it just seems to fit the mood of the moment.

ANN. Some mood. I'm surprised you didn't have me dressed as a French maid.

DAVID. Well, I…

ANN. Just stop.

DAVID. Oh, and I suspect that you remember it differently.

ANN. It certainly wasn't a late night Skinemax movie. And I at least had some sense of self control. Fiery Love Beast?

DAVID. Well, you COULD have said it. Just to be polite.

ANN. Here's how it REALLY happened, Love beast….

(*Flashback)*

DAVID. HI! I'M DAVID!

ANN. Uh, hello…

DAVID. GREAT PARTY, HUH?

ANN. Yeah—where is Paul? I was supposed to meet him here….

DAVID. Monkey Butt! MONKEY BUTT!

ANN. What?

DAVID. Snot! FART BUBBLES!

(*Return to present)*

DAVID. Now wait a minute…why do I suddenly have Tourette's Syndrome?

ANN. It livens up my memory of the event. What's the problem?

DAVID. I've never yelled "monkey butt" in my life.

ANN. But you have to admit it is incredibly funny.

DAVID. Please—FOCUS. Now, back to your side of the story, with NO Fart Bubbles.

ANN. Killjoy.

DAVID. Ahem.

(*Flashback)*

DAVID. Paul is my roommate! I let him cheat off me in Algebra and he gives me his dad's old Hustler magazines!

ANN. Oh, really….

DAVID. Do you want to go see my room? I have every single Flintstone jelly glass, in mint condition.

ANN. I don't…uh…

DAVID. Oh, don't worry—I can tell you are really attracted to me.

ANN. I am?

DAVID. Of course. It's science. (*snorts*) Body chemicals. You have needs that only a man can satisfy.

ANN. I really don't think that.

DAVID. It's pheromones. I know I'm hot. My Mom says its because I have a healthy musk odor. I suppose we should start kissing with our tongues now.

ANN. WHAT?

DAVID. "If you want my body, AND you think I'm sexy…"

ANN. (*starts laughing*) My God, you are a geek.

(*Return to present)*

DAVID. Well, this is your memory of me—and I KNOW for a fact I did not sing when we met.

ANN. Thank God. That would have sent me running away screaming.

DAVID. You were better off. Paul drank like a fish. (*pause*) What is it like, being…

ANN. Dead?

DAVID. Yes. That.

ANN. It's hard to explain. Once you get past the part of feasting on the blood of the living and carving out brains with your bare hands.

DAVID. Just stop that! I'm being serious.

ANN. Actually, it's all right. But you miss people. What were you doing when you heard the news?

DAVID. That you had….

ANN. Died. That's what they call it.

DAVID. I was at home. Your parents called me. Car accident. Quick. No pain.

ANN. That had to be rough. Did you go?

DAVID. Where?

ANN. Branson, Missouri. To my funeral, you moron!

DAVID. Of course.

ANN. What it nice?

DAVID. I suppose. There were lots of flowers, people crying, chicken salad sandwiches afterward, you know - standard stuff.

ANN. No Viking funeral? That would have been so cool. Set me off on a flaming canoe. Flames-FLAMES! (*pause)* I was really touched by what you said.

DAVID. When?

ANN. At my funeral. When you gave the eulogy.

DAVID. HA! You <u>were</u> there!

ANN. Of course—it was my funeral. Who else was in the box?

DAVID. You know what I mean!

ANN. Yes, I do. I remember that you said, "Memories cannot die, if we treat them with love." That was sweet. You also said, "God gave us memory…"

BOTH. "…so we could have roses in December."

DAVID. I always loved you.

ANN. I know. I loved you, too.

DAVID. I still do. That's the problem.

(*Flashback)*

ANN. Hi. This party is sure loud.

DAVID. What?

ANN. (*shouting over noise)* I SAID THIS PARTY IS SURE LOUD!

DAVID. Oh, yeah! My name's David.

ANN. I'm Ann. I'm here to see Paul.

DAVID. Who?

ANN. (*shouting)* PAUL. I'M-HIS—BLIND-DATE.

DAVID. Oh, Paul is throwing up right now.
ANN. Oh.
DAVID. I can go get him.
ANN. No—not if he's…busy. You know Paul?
DAVID. We're roommates.
ANN. Oh, that's nice.
DAVID. WHAT?
ANN. I said, THAT'S NICE!
DAVID. Hey—it's loud in here—do you want to go outside?
ANN. What about Paul?
DAVID. He has a pretty tight grip on the toilet seat. He won't drown.
ANN. GOOD. OKAY.
DAVID. OKAY WHAT?
ANN. LET'S GO OUTSIDE OKAY!

(*Return to present)*
DAVID. (*goes back to writing*) And that's how it started for us…
ANN. Not really romantic, but things got better.
DAVID. And so we walked. Together. Past the ivy-covered walls of the university dorms. Eventually we held hands to ward off the October chill…and I never wanted that night to end. I still don't. (*DAVID freezes*)

ANN. I always loved you too. I just didn't know it as well as you did, and that scared me. I couldn't tell you then, but I guess I can tell you now. Even when I left, I knew that I would come back to you, some how. Maybe this is best . Being dead is all right. Though, I miss you, even more than I did before. I don't mind being your rose. In fact, it is rather nice. But don't be afraid to move on. Be alive. Write. Maybe in that way, I'll live too. (*kisses DAVID on cheek*) Oh—and by the way—there was no ivy on the walls.
DAVID. Please—LET there be ivy.
ANN. (*sighs*) Whatever.